GOLD STANDARD · VERBATIM DIET POSTER

NO REGULATORY BANNER — EXEMPT REPTILE
Outside USDA / TPWD jurisdiction. Husbandry per LIFE protocol.

[photo]

YELLOW-FOOTED TORTOISE

Chelonoidis denticulatus

RAINFOREST OMNIVORE — Fruit + Greens + Trace Protein

WHAT THIS ANIMAL IS: Forest tortoise — Amazon basin; fruit-tolerant, hay-intolerant as base
SITES: Houston · San Antonio

3-SEC CHECK: Is fruit visible? Is humidity OK?

STANDARD DIET — HEALTHY ANIMALS ONLY

Excludes sick / vet-care / special-diet animals

Covers ~95% of daily feedings. For the remaining 5%, use training and observation within sound science. Unsure — Pause. Ask. Escalate.

MORNING FEED-OUT

Fruit in 1-inch chunks. Whole-leaf greens. Mazuri tortoise diet 1-2×/week. Trace protein.

APPROX DAILY: Per posted portion chart

ENCOUNTER / ENRICHMENT PORTION

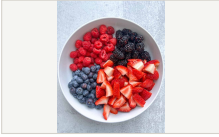
Single fruit cube (½ inch) for hand-feeding. Drawn from daily allocation.

CORRECT 40-50% fruit (tropical) · 30-40% greens + browse · 5% trace protein weekly

Papaya

Mango

Melon


Berries

Collard greens

Mulberry leaves

WRONG — FIX IMMEDIATELY Hay only (this is NOT a Sulcata) · Daily commercial pellet · Daily high-protein

Corn

Carrot

Sweet potato / yam

SIMPLE BUILD

- Fruit in 1-inch chunks (papaya, mango, melon, berries)
- Whole-leaf greens (collard, kale, mulberry)
- Browse branches

PREP RULE

Mazuri Tortoise Diet (LS) 1-2×/week only — NOT daily, NOT base. Trace egg/pellet weekly.

MATCH THE BOWL — DO NOT INTERPRET.

No photo = feeding not complete. · No substitutions without approval. · Unsure → Pause → Ask → Escalate.

POST AT EXHIBIT · DO NOT REMOVE · SUPERSEDES PRIOR DIET CARDS

Source: AZA Chelonian TAG · Chelonoidis denticulatus standards · Verbatim Gold Standard
LIFE Diet Governance System · Gold Standard v2026.04.25 · Match the bowl. Don't interpret.